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Question of Trust

- Victor Canning

I Answer the following Word Meanings:-

a Stirred: Moved slightly or emotionally aroused
sentence. The speach stirred deep emotions.

b persuated: Convinced someone to do or believe something
sentence She persuaded him to stay longer.

c Tickle: Lightly touch to cause laughter or irritation
sentence The feather tickle my nose.

d Hindering: Making something difficult or obstructing
sentence Noise was hindering my concentration.

e Doorway: Entrance through a door
sentance He stood silently in the doorway.

II Reference to Context:-

1 "Before ---------- time."

a Who outsmarted Horrace Damby in the robbery of the jewels?
Ans He was outsmarted by a young lady in red who posed as the owner's wife, tricked him into opening the safe, and made off with the jewels.

Q2 what did young lady ask for?
Ans She asked him to open the safe, claiming she didn't knew its password.

Q3 'forgotten the numbers' here refers to _____.
Ans It refers to the safe's combination numbers - the specific code sequence needed to unlock and open the safe.

Q4 Put the events in the correct sequence:
a I will let the safe mended.
b I need the jewels to wear tonight.
c I forgot the number to open the safe.
d I will open the safe within an hour.

(i) 2, 3, 4, 1 (iii) 1, 2, 3, 4
(ii) 4, 3, 2, 1 (iv) 2, 1, 3, 4

Ans (iv) 2, 1, 3, 4

III Answer the following Short Answers:-

Q1 Why was Horrace Damby sure that his robbery at Shotover Grange would be successful?
Ans Horace Damby was confident because he had studied the house inside out - the drawing room hiding the safe, the wiring, garden paths and the servants' movements - planning every detail so nothing could go wrong.

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Q2 What does the phrase 'honour among theives' means? And why was he angry when someone talks about it?

Ans 'Honour among theives' refers to an unwritten code where criminals refuse to betray one another. Horace Damby became angry because he was decieved by a fellow theif who violated this code, leading to his arrest and disillusionment.

Q3 Horrace Damby was good and respectable but not completely Honest. Illucidate.

Ans Horace Damby appeared dignified, robbing only once a year and exclusively from the wealthy to fund his passion for rare books. His meticulous planning and restraint earned him respect, but his annual theft reveales he wasn't entirely honest, as he violated the law to satisfy personal desires.

IV Answer the following Long answers:-

Q1 Would you do something wrong i.e. commit a crime if you thought that 'ends justify the means'? Do you think that there are certain situations you can be excused for acting dishonestly?

Ans I wouldn't break laws just to achieve a perieved good outcome. Criminal acts undermine the rule of law, erode social stability, and deny fair process that protects everyone. Short term gain can't justify long term harm.

Yet in extreme, life-threatening situations, a lie or low-level dishonesty - misleading an attacker or covering a vulnerable person - can feel defensible. Those rare moments call for balancing harm reduction against strict moral rules.

Even so, each exeption demands scrutiny. Dishonesty, however well-intentioned, corrodes trust and invites escalation. It's better to seek transparent solutions that align means with ends wherever possible.

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